

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK



For Internal Circulation Only

Date of Release - April 2026

Version 3

Together, we are creating a pleasant work environment, where we can unlock our true potential, attract best talent worldwide, learn grow and contribute meaningfully to the continuously evolving world around us.

This comprehensive handbook has been designed to provide you with the deeper understanding about your company's policies and quick reference to all aspects related to your employment.

Though it's our intent to provide comprehensive understanding by covering all the potential scenarios, but no handbook can cover every situation. If you have questions regarding the policies, please reach out to your manager or the HR team, they will be happy to help.

We believe in the philosophy of "continuous improvement". As we grow as a company, we will introduce new policies or amend existing ones, to align with the changing needs of the business and the employees. This employee handbook gets updated once a year with those changes.

Please read through the policies contained in this document. It includes policies, processes and benefits offered by the company. It shares our journey and gives insights to our values and principles that bind us together.

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ABOUT SAMTA

Warm welcome to the **SAMTA** family that strives to be the preferred global partner in providing human centered technology solutions globally.

We can't wait to see what you will achieve with us. This employee handbook defines who we are and how we work together. It's a collection of our expectations, commitments, and responsibilities. Please read this employee handbook carefully and consult it whenever you need to.

SAMTA.ai is a human-centric product & Data + AI company. We are passionate about creating best in class global solutions to help companies maximize IMPACT, monetize DATA, generate VALUE, and drive INNOVATION. We bring technology to life for Enterprises and Startups.

OUR EVOLUTION

We started as a product & solutions company to cater cross-border Real Estate technology needs in mid 2017, enabling nonresident Investors to invest and manage their assets remotely through our technology platform – Homzhub.

Covid forced us to figure out how to survive in trenches and pivot the company. Since 2022, we have evolved as product & services company to focus on Tech Consulting, Product Engineering, Data, AI, RPA as well as Talent augmentation and Staffing services under the umbrella of **SAMTA.ai**

OUR DNA – VISION, MISSION, VALUES AND FIRST PRINCIPLES

VISION

Enhance human potential by unlocking true power of Data and ethical AI

MISSION

We are on a mission to provide world class frictionless digital experience by designing human centered products & solutions for our clients to address their business needs, using cutting edge technologies, real time data and reliable service, in transparent and professional manner, while respecting their confidentiality. We always strive to deliver high quality human-centric, scalable and sustainable solutions to our clients.

CORE VALUES

- I. **Innovation**
- II. **Integrity** (Accountability & Reliability)
- III. **Excellence** (Result Orientation / Impact focus)
- IV. **Collaboration** (Teamwork)
- V. **Respect** (Being Human / empathetic)

FIRST PRINCIPLES

These first principles are DNA of our CULTURE and should be used as foundation principles in our decision making process, across the organization.

1. Client Centricity
2. Growth mindset (Be curious, Learn & Grow)
3. Challenge status quo (Drive innovation)
4. Be Accountable
5. Diversity, equality, & inclusiveness (DEI)
6. Data driven decision making
7. Take bold radical bets with scientific rigor (Think-Experiment-Analyze-Rethink-Repeat)
8. Hire, nurture & retain best talent
9. Bias for action
10. Achieve results & measure impact
11. High standards on all fronts
12. Be frugal
13. Think deep; disagree, and commit
14. Benefit all stakeholders (People, Planet & Community)

EMPLOYMENT BASICS

In this section, we explain different employee contract types and define our basic employment policies.

EMPLOYMENT TYPES

1. Full-time employees (FTEs)
2. Part-time employees
3. Consultants/Contract Employees
4. Trainees under our Flagship Talent Development Program (TDP)
5. Internships

Full-time and part-time employees can have either a temporary or indefinite duration of contracts. Full-time employees under an indefinite duration contract are entitled to our company's full benefits package.

PROBATION

All recruits and interns who have been regularized after completing their TDP will be under probation for a period of 6 months.

The performance shall be assessed during the probation period, and the manager will submit a report at the end of the probation period. She/he shall be confirmed subject to satisfactory performance during the probation period. The employee is deemed to be under probation unless a confirmation letter is issued.

EQUAL OPPORTUNITY EMPLOYMENT

SAMTA is an equal opportunity employer. We strongly discourage discrimination against protected characteristics (gender, age, sexual orientation, race, nationality, ethnicity, religion, disability, veteran status). We want all employees (including executives and HR) to treat others with respect and professionalism. We use inclusive, diverse, sensitive language in all official documents, signs, and job ads. In practice, this means that we:

Hire and promote talent based on meritocracy, skills, competencies, experience or potential while attempting to eliminate bias in every step.

Apart from those actions, we commit to penalizing every discriminatory, offensive or inappropriate behavior. We seek your help to report any discriminatory action against yourself or your colleagues to the Human Resources. At all times the identity of whistleblower shall be protected.

The company maintains a strict non-retaliation policy for employees who file complaints of discrimination. Acts of retaliation or discrimination by any employee will be met with appropriate disciplinary action

REMUNERATION POLICIES

All employees get their Annual salary (Base + Variable) in the form of monthly pay in 12 months. The compensation & Benefits Structure of the company is based on a combination of Cost to Company (CTC), and Performance linked Incentives.

REMUNERATION COMPONENTS

The Company's compensation model consists of the following elements as part of the remuneration.

- Base Salary
- Special Allowance (SA)
- Health Insurance & Benefits (HIB)
- Retirement Benefits (PF, ESIC & Gratuity)
- Individual Performance Variable

Salaries will be disbursed in the 1st week of every month for the preceding month. If the pay day happens to be a Sunday/Public Holiday, the disbursement shall be done on the next working day.

INDIVIDUAL PERFORMANCE INCENTIVE

The performance Incentives are disbursed in mid-term and year end, depending on eligibility.

All confirmed employees who meet or surpass, their OKRs are eligible for performance-based incentives. The Incentive will be prorated as applicable. Payout is driven by management guidelines as announced for the respective performance periods under performance and compensation guidelines. Performance Linked incentives will not be paid to employees who have resigned from the services of the company as on the date of payment and are serving notice period.

DEDUCTION OF INCOME TAX

Based on the applicable compensation at the start of new financial year, the total earnings are projected for the entire financial year, and tax shall be deducted in equal monthly installments.

Any one-time payment being made to the employee will be fully taxed, as applicable, in the month it is being paid.

BANK DETAILS

All employees are required to have an HDFC account for salary credit. An employee is required to open a HDFC salary account if they don't have one and provide the following details to HR by 25th of the month of joining-

- Bank Account Number
- Name as per Bank records
- IFSC Code of Bank

Salary Reviews

All confirmed employees will be considered for an annual salary review. Reviews are based on performance, change in job roles/responsibilities, and market benchmarking. Any salary review will happen in accordance with the prevalent compensation policy. The company reserves the right to review structure, entitlements, process and compensation policy as it deems fit.

INFORMATION SECURITY POLICIES

To secure Samta, we have developed a comprehensive guideline on usage of information, Data, AI, and technology. Please refer to the policy document – [Samta Information Security Policy v1.1](#). A brief version of few Dos' and Dont's are summarized here for your reference:

CONFIDENTIALITY AND DATA PROTECTION

We want to ensure that confidential information about clients, employees, partners and our company is well-protected. Examples of confidential information include but not limited to:

- Employee records
- Unpublished financial information
- Data related to customers/partners/vendors
- Customer lists (existing and prospective)
- Unpublished goals, forecasts and initiatives marked as confidential
- Non-compete and non-disclosure agreements (NDAs) etc.

We are also committed to:

- Restrict and monitor access to sensitive data
- Develop transparent data collection procedures
- Train employees in online privacy and security measures
- Build secure networks to protect online data from cyber attacks
- Establish data protection practices (e.g. secure locks, data encryption, frequent backups, access authorization).

We also expect you to act responsibly when handling confidential information.

You **MUST**:

- Always lock or secure confidential information
- Shred confidential documents when they're no longer needed
- Make sure you view confidential information on secure devices only
- Only disclose information to other employees when it's necessary and authorized
- Confidential documents should always be inside our company's offices.

You must **NOT**:

- Use confidential information for your personal benefit or profit.
- Disclose confidential information to anyone inside or outside of our company.
- Replicate confidential documents and files and store them on insecure devices.

This policy is important for our company's legal standing and reputation. Company has a right to terminate any employee who breaches our confidentiality guidelines for personal profit. We may also discipline any unintentional breach of this policy depending on its frequency and seriousness. We will terminate employees who repeatedly disregard this policy, even when they do so unintentionally.

INTELLECTUAL PROPERTY

During the employment with the Company, what we create, invent or develop belongs to the Company. This includes inventions, discoveries, ideas, designs, software programs including all improvements, whether created or made using the Company time, resources or information belonging to the Company. We must promptly disclose to the company in writing any such work product and cooperate with the Company to obtain legal protection over them.

TECHNOLOGY ASSETS

DESKTOP / LAPTOP / MOBILE DEVICES

The organization may provide all Employees (Full & part time), TDPs / Interns or Consultants, with a company devices for official work purposes. Every device will be assigned a Unique Asset Identification Number and recorded in the company's asset management system.

Employees are responsible for maintaining the devices in good condition and use it strictly for work-related activities.

EMPLOYEES' ACCOUNTABILITY

All Employees are expected to exercise due care and responsible for safe handling, & security of the devices. They must protect the device from damage, prevent unauthorized access or disclosure of organizational information, and comply with Samta's IT policies, including restrictions on unauthorized or pirated software.

Devices and the data contained within, are the sole and exclusive property of the company. Employees possessing devices are accountable for its safe custody and protection. Please note that all and any information stored on the devices is considered organization property and will therefore be open to access, monitor and audit remotely by the organization.

The devices issued to the employee must always, be protected from unauthorized access using effective and necessary security measures, including but not limited to password protection, biometric access control, VPN access to the network, and Encryption of data on the fly or in transit.

DAMAGE & LOSS

Any damage caused to the devices due to negligence, mishandling, or misuse by the employee may lead to recovery of repair or replacement costs. In cases where the damage is due to technical or system malfunction, the IT team will evaluate and address the issue accordingly.

If the device is lost or stolen, the employee must immediately inform their reporting manager and the HR team with all the relevant details. In addition, the employee must also file a police complaint or FIR and submit a copy of the same to HR, regardless of whether the loss occurred:

- During travel or outside the office premises, or
- Within the office premises.

The organization reserves the right to determine liability and recovery based on the findings of the internal review.

RETURNING THE DEVICES

Employees must handover the company-issued devices, along with the ID card and any other company assets, at the time of the separation.

The device must be returned in proper working condition, subject to normal wear and tear. Asset verification will be conducted before providing the final clearance for exit formalities.

WORKPLACE POLICIES

HARASSMENT (VERBAL & PHYSICAL)

Harassment is a broad term and may include seemingly harmless actions, like gossip. We can't create an exhaustive list, but here are some instances that we consider harassment:

- Sabotaging someone's work on purpose
- Engaging in frequent or unwanted advances of any nature
- Commenting derogatorily on a person's ethnic heritage or religious beliefs
- Starting or spreading rumors about a person's personal life
- Ridiculing someone in front of others or singling them out to perform tasks unrelated to their job against their will.

Sexual harassment is illegal, and we will seriously investigate relevant reports. If an employee is found guilty of sexual harassment, they will be terminated. If you're being harassed, whether-by a colleague, customer or vendor, you are encouraged to talk to any of the HR Partners.

Offenders: If you suspect that an offender doesn't realize they are guilty of harassment, you could talk to them directly to resolve the harassment. This tactic is appropriate for cases of minor harassment (e.g. inappropriate jokes). Avoid using this approach with customers or other stakeholders.

Reporting Manager: If customers, other stakeholders or team members are involved in your claim, you may reach out to your manager. Your manager will assess your situation and may contact HR if appropriate.

HR Representative: Feel free to reach out to HR in any case of harassment no matter how minor it may seem. For your safety, contact HR as soon as possible in cases of serious harassment (e.g. sexual advances) or if your manager is involved in your claim. Anything you disclose will always remain confidential.

Employees are encouraged to read the POSH (Prevention of Sexual Harassment) policy to get better understanding of it. [SAMTA POSH Policy.pdf](#)

VIOLENCE (VERBAL & PHYSICAL)

Violence in our workplace is a serious form of harassment. It includes verbal, physical and sexual assault, destruction of property, threats to harm a person or property and verbal and psycho- logical abuse. We want to avoid those incidents altogether, but we also want to be ready to respond if needed. For this reason, we ask you to:

- Report to HR if you suspect or know that someone is being violent. Your report will be confidential, and we will investigate the situation with discretion.
- Call our building's security if you witness incidents of severe physical violence (e.g. ones that involve a lethal weapon.) For your safety, avoid getting involved.

We will treat employees who orally threaten others as high risk, and they will receive an appropriate penalty. If HR finds that an employee commits an act of violence, we will terminate that employee and possibly press criminal charges. Employees who damage property deliberately will be solely responsible for paying for the damages.

SAFETY AND HEALTH

Our company is committed to creating a hazard-free, safe, and secure workplace environment. To this end, we will ensure workplace safety through preventative action and emergency management.

Preventative actions are any actions we take to avoid injuries or illnesses related to the workplace. We will periodically conduct risk assessments and job hazard analyses [through a work-place safety committee] to uncover health risks to employees. And we will establish preventative measures to address risks accordingly.

We also expect you to take safety seriously. Always use protective equipment and follow standards whenever necessary. If you deliberately disregard our guidelines, we may terminate you for your own and others' safety.

WORK GUIDELINES

ATTENDANCE

All employees are required to report to office. We expect you to be present during your scheduled working hours. If you face an emergency that prevents you from coming to work any day, contact your manager or HR as soon as possible to discuss your next steps.

We will excuse unreported absences in cases of [serious accidents, acute medical emergencies]. Aside these exceptions, we expect you to take prior approval from Manager & HR for any day off.

On joining, each employee will receive user id and password from HR for access to the Employee portal "Matrix". Employees are required to mark their attendance daily on the system.

COMPENSATORY DAY OFF

Any cancellations of approved planned leave for unplanned work requested by client or management, on your scheduled pre-approved leave holiday, the employee will be eligible for a Compensatory Off (Comp-Off).

Comp-offs exist as a last resort - not a routine affair. Our expectation is that proactive planning and flexible scheduling will make this a rare exception, not a recurring cultural norm.

Justification: The requirement must be justified by the Project Manager (PM) based on critical delivery needs, substantiate by the written request from the client and approved by the management.

Verification: The actual hours worked must be verified against timesheet logs by leads

Approval: Final eligibility for a Comp-Off is subject to approval by the **HOD & HR**.

Note on Compensatory Off (Comp-Off) Utilization: A Compensatory Off is strictly intended to provide rest following an operational stretch. To maintain project continuity, Comp-Offs cannot be clubbed with any other leave types (Earned Leave or Sick Leave). There shall be no exception to this rule.

TIMESHEET COMPLIANCE

Daily Timesheet Logging – Please update your timesheet by EOD every day. Avoid bulk-filling at the end of the week to ensure your work is accurately represented. If the timesheet log is missing for any day, it will be categorized as an 'Unaccounted Absence'. Failure to update your timesheet will result in a Loss of Pay (LOP) for that specific day. Timesheet data is often requested by clients to justify billable hours, track productivity and planning resource allocations to achieve operational excellence.

TIME TRACKING FOR ABSENCES

To ensure accurate timekeeping and compliance, employees must punch their in and out times for all work-related absences, including brief departures from the office. Failure to record, regardless of duration or frequency, is a violation of the attendance policy.

This includes stepping out for personal errands, meetings outside the office, or any other work-related or personal absence during work hours (other than designated break period). Tailgating is not allowed at any point of time and will be considered as an offence.

WORK FROM HOME (WFH):

Work From Home (WFH) is provided as a contingency to support employees during regular working days in the event of unforeseen emergencies that prevent them from coming to the office. **It is not intended to be utilized in conjunction with public holidays or scheduled vacations or sick leaves.**

All confirmed employees can use up to 4 days' Work from Home (WFH) **per quarter**, subject to the following:

- These days are non-transferable and cannot be rolled over
- Normal working hours are expected on approved WFH days.
- Prior HR approval is mandatory over mail
- In our HR system – Matrix, attendance needs to be marked choosing the WFH option

It is advised that employees use this option judiciously and **productivity is not hampered** on the said days. The **reporting manager** needs to ensure that the assigned tasks for the day are validated before the EOD. Failure to deliver the planned tasks needs to be highlighted to HOD & HR.

Adherence to WFH protocols is mandatory. Any employee found in violation of these norms will have their remote work privileges revoked for the remainder of the calendar year, and the said days will be treated as LOP.

No further WFH requests will be approved. Please apply for leave if further time off is needed.

LEAVE POLICY

SAMTA believes in holistic development and the well-being of its people. Employees are encouraged to take time off from work as in when needed to manage work life balance, rejuvenate & recover their energies, pursue their passion and spend quality time with their family & friends.

Your entitlement for leave will be applicable after the completion of the probation period.

EARNED / PRIVILEGED LEAVES (ELS/PLS):

You are entitled to **fifteen (15) days** of earned leave per financial year (Earned / Privileged Leave), which cannot be carried forward in the following year and need to be consumed in the same year. Leave is based on financial year and will be allocated on a pro-rata basis depending on your date of commencement of employment and subsequent confirmation with the Company.

Note: These leaves cannot be prefaced or suffixed with Sick Leave.

All leave must be pre-approved by your project manager and HR, subject to the operational requirements of the business. There is no encashment of any Leave during the tenure of service or at the time of separation.

Mandatory Approval: Failure to get approval on the leave in Matrix, 4 weeks prior the commencement, will result in the leave being considered as **Leave Without Pay (LOP)**. The organization will not process requests to reverse or amend such LOP deductions.

Leave Planning: Leave requests tend to cluster heavily toward the end of the financial year. While we understand the impulse to save up, but we may **NOT** be able to approve bulk leave requests during that time due to business needs. Any leave more than 3 days will require at least 4 weeks prior approval from your Manager and HR in the system. Adequate time is needed to plan, backup resources, during your leave, so work doesn't get disrupted.

Leaves that cannot be approved are leaves you lose on. We don't want that. Plan and consume your leave judiciously throughout the year to avoid any disruption to your work. Take them when business is quieter, or simply when you need a break. Your wellbeing matters, throughout the year.

SICK LEAVES (SLS):

You will be entitled to **six (6) Sick Leaves** in a year and need to be consumed in the same year. Leave is based on financial year and will be allocated on pro rata basis depending on your date of commencement of employment and subsequent confirmation with the Company.

If leave is taken due to health reasons – for more than two days, employees are required to produce a medical certificate. Please apply “SL” – in leave application in HRMS (HR Management System) on our Matrix Platform (ERP Next) besides informing HR and immediate supervisor. For emergency leave, employee must inform his/her reporting manager and inform on the official company group.

This leave is not eligible for cash redemption, either during employment or upon separation.

During the probationary period, employees are entitled to a maximum of three (3) days of sick leave.

Important Note: No leaves shall be carried forward to next year. Hence, it's mandated and healthy for employee and organization to avail time off!

BIRTHDAY LEAVE

Full-Time Employees can take a paid day off on their special day.

WELLBEING LEAVE

At **SAMTA** we emphasize and give importance to well-being of both the body and the mind.

In line with our, "People First" philosophy, wherein we believe in holistic development of our employees, we are delighted to introduce our Employee Wellness initiative where the employees can choose to attend the 10-day Vipassana course once in a year at any of the centers in India. All employees, upon confirmation, are eligible to avail this benefit.

These 10 days would be sponsored by the company and would be over and above your total leave entitlements. Please connect with HR whenever you wish to avail the benefit. *Employees serving notice period are not eligible for this benefit.

MATERNITY LEAVE

The maternity policy aims to provide maternity benefits to all full-time female employees, who are on the rolls of the organization, in accordance with the benefits accorded by the Government of India.

As an inclusive employer for the benefit of the employees and business continuity we offer two options:

OPTION 1

Paid Leave for 26 calendar weeks, up to 2 children. The leave may commence 8 weeks prior to the expected date of confinement and 18 weeks immediately after the delivery. The maternity leaves are inclusive of weekends and holidays.

OPTION 2

If the employee wishes to resume work 120 days (4 months) post-delivery, she will have an option to resume part time/flexi hours, work from home, upto 8 months from the start of leave period:

Period	Work Hours	Salary
Post 120 days Maternity Leave	4	50% of salary

The employee is at liberty to choose the option she wishes to avail based on one's individual situation and inform HR in writing at the time of commencement of the leave in the best interest of the organization.

Important Notes:

- Employee continues to be covered under the organization's health and insurance policy during the period of Maternity Leave.
- The Annual Individual performance variable and the company bonus payment, if applicable, shall be paid pro-rated to the number of months worked before starting the leave.
- Employees are required to notify their supervisors at least 3 months before the start of the expected date of birth/adoption.
- A medical certificate from an authorized Medical Practitioner specifying the pregnancy and the expected date of delivery and confinement period shall be submitted to the HR along with the application to avail maternity Leave.
- Company will allow Unpaid Maternity Leave to female employees who are under ESIC bracket and

employee need to avail all Maternity benefit through local ESIC authorities only.

- Any employee who has availed 4 months or more of Maternity leave and wishes to resign at the end of maternity leave is required to serve the stipulated notice period as per the company's policy.

MISCARRIAGE LEAVE

Paid leave of maximum up to 6 weeks in case of miscarriage or medically terminated pregnancy. It needs to be supported by a medical certificate by a registered Medical Practitioner certifying the need for leave mentioning the number of days.

ADOPTION LEAVE

Paid Leave of 12 calendar weeks in case of adoption of child below 3 months of age is applicable for all female employees for up to 2 children.

PATERNITY LEAVE

All male employees who are on the rolls of the company are entitled to avail paid paternity leave of up to 5 days within first 15 days of the birth of the child.

BEREAVEMENT LEAVE

To cope with the irreparable loss of an immediate family member all the employees can take 2 days' leave. Immediate Family is defined as: Parents, In-laws, Spouse, Children, Siblings.

PUBLIC HOLIDAYS

Public Holidays would be as per the annual holiday list declared at the start of the year and listed in the Appendix of this document. Public Holidays are applicable for all confirmed, probationary FTEs, interns and consultants.

LEAVES WITHOUT PRIOR APPROVAL

Employees taking leave without prior approval on return are required to furnish documentary evidence for their leave of absence. Leave without prior approval is a serious behavioral misconduct on the part of the employee. Following course of action will be taken for repeat instances:

- For the first time, an employee is given a warning and explained the consequences of this action, if repeated in future aside the Leave without pay for the said period.
- On the second instance, the employee will be given formal warning and will be subject to deduction of pay for said number of days.
- On subsequent instance, employee may face serious consequences such as suspension from the work, demotion, impact on performance review, dismissal & termination of employment.

PROCESS:

All employees are required to follow the standard operating procedure (SOPs) to exercise leave:

All leaves by confirmed or probation employees (except leaves due to health reason/family emergency) should be approved by their reporting managers as per the following:

- If the leaves are taken for less than 3 days, then one-week prior approval is required in the Matrix.

- For leave more than 3 days, the employee is required to apply and get approval in Matrix four weeks prior to the event.
- Submit Leave application in HRMS (HR Management System) on Matrix Platform (ERPNext) with all the required details.
- Inform your supervisor regarding submission of the application and make sure there is no overlap with other team members from the same team.
- Get prior approval and discuss the business continuity plan (who will take care of your responsibilities) with your Reporting manager.

MISCELLANEOUS POLICIES

BUSINESS TRAVEL

The business travel policy endeavors to provide reasonable comfort to employees while on travel to other cities/country, to ensure the effective discharge of their duties. Travelling plans should always be approved by Reporting Manager /Head of the Department (HOD).

Entitlements:

The boarding and lodging limits, mode of travel, incidental expenses are fixed according to the classification of city / country as per the band of the employee. Transit and incidental expenses are applicable for travel beyond 4 hours only. All expenses can be claimed with supporting bills. Employees are required to submit original bills.

CAREER MOBILITY

The policy has been designed with the objective of promoting and retaining talent within the company. Based on the availability of openings, employees can request transfer/relocation, department or function. The final decision would be made by the management subject to role fitment. Management may depute any employee for outstation duty in connection with work with proper arrangements and guidelines.

CELEBRATING LIFE MOMENTS

As a family, we like to celebrate life moments of our colleagues and be part of their celebrations. On your special occasions, you are eligible for following:

- **Wedding:** Gift vouchers worth up to INR 5000/- for the couple.
- **Childbirth:** Gift vouchers up to INR 2500/- for the new parents.

EMPLOYEE ENGAGEMENTS

At **SAMTA**, we work hard and party hard. We do monthly birthday celebrations for all the birthdays in the month on the last Friday of the month. Regional festival celebrations aside celebrating the success of projects and individual contributions.

Annually, we plan a team retreat to build stronger connections among all peers. These annual retreats are great opportunities to get to know your colleagues from other cities and functions as well as spend time with the Management team to get to know the direction of the company, celebrate achievements and understand growth plans.

PROFESSIONAL GROWTH

SAMTA encourages employees to continuously upgrade their skills and knowledge through professional certifications, which are demonstrably of value to both the employee and the company.

Eligibility: One year of service as FTE. Employee can enroll in a professional course which is relevant to the current or future role requirement and is approved by Reporting Manager and HOD

Entitlement: 50% of the total fees or INR 20,000, whichever is less per year (1 year from the date of last reimbursement)

Note: In case any professional development certification is approved by the company for employees who have not completed a year, the reimbursement for the same will be done in 4 equated instalments.

Recovery: In case the employee resigns from the company within a year 12 months from the date of the reimbursement, 100% of the reimbursed amount paid for certifications and related activities shall be recovered from Full & Final settlement.

EMPLOYEE REFERRAL POLICY

The employee referral policy aims to recognize and reward the employees who take the initiative to refer qualified candidates to join the organization.

Eligibility:

Any employee can refer a suitable candidate as per the Job Description whenever a job is posted by the HR Team.

Exceptions:

- Employees in HR function
- Managers part of the hiring process for the position under consideration
- Managers who are part of the same team and have a direct or indirect reporting relationship.

Referral Bonus:

The employees will be eligible for a Referral Bonus only if the referee gets selected and joins the company and successfully completes the probation period.

Employee Category	Amount
FTE	INR 5000
Consultants (Contract)	INR 2500

Process of Referral:

- Employee shares the profile of the candidate mentioning the Job Posting Details to the HR
- If the profile is found suitable, the HR team will reach out to the candidate
- In case the candidate is already in the database the HR team will inform the same to the employee, and the employee shall not be eligible for Referral Bonus
- The selection will be based purely on merit. The decision of the interviewing panel will be final
- The referral bonus will be paid after the referee completes the probation period, provided both referred employee and referee are on the payroll during the time of payout.

Claims of referral after the candidate is interviewed or joins will not be entertained. In the event if resume is received by two sources the person/place from where it was received first would be treated as the “source” and would be eligible for referral accordingly. All decisions pertaining to the policy will be taken by management and shall be deemed as final. The management has the right to alter, withdraw or modify any or all aspects of the Employee Referral Program without assigning any reason.

EMPLOYEE CODE OF CONDUCT

As an employee, all company policies mentioned above apply to you. We expect that your behavior to be professional. We can't cover every single case of conduct, but we trust you to always use your best judgement. Reach out to your manager or HR if you face any issues or have any questions.

GENERAL CONDUCT

All employees are expected to exhibit professionalism and practice ethical behavior. Employees are not allowed to accept any gifts, cash or kind from any vendors on behalf of the company.

WORKING WEEK & TIMINGS

All our offices follow 5 days' work Week (Monday to Friday) and the timings will be 9 am to 6pm with an hour of lunch break.

PUNCTUALITY

An employee must be punctual at work. Habitual late arrival or leaving early without management approval shall be considered misconduct, and disciplinary action shall be initiated.

DRESS CODE

Our company's official dress code is Formal on Weekdays and Smart Casuals on Friday with appropriate shoes. However, an employee's position may also guide how they should dress. If you frequently meet clients or prospects, conform to a more formal dress code. We expect you to be modestly and professionally dressed when coming to work. **Floaters are strictly prohibited.**

We also respect and permit grooming styles, clothing, and accessories that are dictated by religious beliefs, ethnicity, or disability. Employees are requested to display the highest standards in maintaining a professional image of the organization.

CONFIDENTIALITY OF COMPENSATION INFORMATION

Compensation details are classified as highly confidential. All employees are required to keep their compensation information confidential and not discuss such matters with anyone except their manager or HR Manager. Management takes a serious view of this matter, and disciplinary action shall be taken against employees who breach this condition of service.

CLIENT & TEAM MEETINGS

All employees are expected to report to or login to all meetings a few minutes prior to the start of the meeting. It shall be considered disrespectful and unprofessional if you are habitually late for the meetings. In case of any emergency, please keep the members informed in advance as much as possible.

EXTERNAL COMMUNICATION

SAMTA seeks to establish a constructive and productive relationship with its clients. Only employees authorized by **SAMTA** are permitted to interact with the client. In any situation when the employee is approached directly by the client for any subject beyond their purview, they should direct them to the Project Manager for the said project.

COMPANY PROPERTY

The company provides resources to employees to perform their job effectively. The company intends that these resources, which include the following but are not limited to office supplies, software, and electronic communication systems, are used for company purposes only. The company's resources such as email, phone, and fax are meant for business and official use only and should not be used for personal /private purposes.

CYBERSECURITY AND DIGITAL DEVICES

This section deals with all digital things at work. We want to set some guidelines for using computers, phones, our internet connection, and social media to ensure security and protect our assets.

INTERNET USAGE

Our corporate internet connection is primarily for business. But you can occasionally use our connection for personal purposes if they don't interfere with your job responsibilities. Also, we expect you to temporarily halt personal activities that slow down our internet connection (e.g. uploading photos) if you're asked to.

You must not use our internet connection to:

- Download or upload obscene, offensive or illegal material
- Send confidential information to unauthorized recipients
- Invade another person's privacy and gain access to sensitive information
- Download or upload pirated movies, music, material or software
- Visit potentially dangerous websites that compromise our network and computers' safety
- Perform unauthorized or illegal actions, like hacking, fraud or buying/selling illegal goods.

CELL PHONE

We allow use of cell phones at work. But we also want to ensure that your devices won't distract you from your work or disrupt our workplace. We ask you to follow a few simple rules:

- Use your cell phone in a manner that benefits your work (business calls, productivity apps, calendars)
- Keep personal calls brief and use an empty meeting room or common area so as not to disturb your colleagues
- Avoid picking up the calls while in meeting and in conversation with colleagues and clients
- Avoid playing games on your phone or texting excessively
- Avoid using your phone for any reason while driving a company vehicle
- Don't use your phone to record confidential information
- Don't download or upload inappropriate, illegal or obscene material using our corporate internet connection.

CORPORATE EMAIL

Email is essential to our work. You should use your company's email primarily for work, but we allow some uses of your company's email for personal reasons.

You can use your corporate email for work-related purposes without limitations. For example, you can sign up for newsletters and online services that will help you in your job or professional growth.

Our general expectations No matter how you use your corporate email, we expect you to avoid:

- Signing up for illegal, unreliable, disreputable or suspect websites and services
- Sending unauthorized marketing content or emails
- Registering for a competitor's services, unless authorized
- Sending insulting or discriminatory messages and content
- Intentionally spamming other people's emails, including your coworkers.

SOCIAL MEDIA

We want to provide practical advice to prevent careless use of social media in our workplace. We address two types of social media uses: using personal social media at work and representing our company through social media.

Using personal social media at work:

You are permitted to access your personal accounts at work. But we expect you to act responsibly according to our policies and ensure that you stay productive. Specifically, we ask you to: Discipline yourself. Avoid getting sidetracked by your social platforms.

- Ensure others know that your personal account or statements don't represent our company. For example, use a disclaimer such as "opinions are my own."
- Avoid sharing intellectual property (e.g trademarks) or confidential information. Ask your manager or PR first before you share company news that's not officially announced.
- Avoid any defamatory, offensive, or derogatory content. You may violate our company's anti-harassment policy if you direct such content towards colleagues, clients, or partners.
- If you handle our social media accounts or speak on our company's behalf, we expect you to protect our company's image and reputation. Specifically, you should:
 - Be respectful, polite, and patient
 - Avoid speaking on matters outside your field of expertise when possible
 - Follow our confidentiality and data protection policies and observe laws governing copyrights, trademarks, plagiarism and fair use
 - Coordinate with our [PR/Marketing department] when you're about to share any major-impact content
 - Avoid deleting or ignoring comments for no reason
 - Correct or remove any misleading or false content as soon as possible.

SMOKING

SAMTA is a smoke-free workplace. You can smoke in [designated smoking areas] Any other area in our workplace (like restrooms, lobby, offices, staircases, warehouses) is strictly smoke-free to protect non-smokers. We also advise you to:

- Extinguish your cigarettes and discard them in [outdoor ashtrays, cigarette burns].
- Avoid smoking when you have scheduled meetings with clients or vendors.
- Avoid smoking near flammable objects and areas.
- Setting off fire alarms and causing fires by smoking amounts to serious offence.

If you are found responsible, you may face disciplinary action up to and including termination.

CONFLICT OF INTEREST

SAMTA requires that each employee exercise the highest ethical standards and conform to a code of conduct compatible with our mission and values. Employees should be free of any personal interests which could influence their judgment. Similarly, they must avoid any situation which puts their interests in direct conflict with those of **SAMTA**. Moonlighting is strictly prohibited and would lead to termination if found guilty.

To maintain fairness and professionalism, employees must avoid conflict of interest involving personal relationships. Employees will not directly supervise or influence the employment of relatives. Referrals of relatives are acceptable; however, they cannot work in the same reporting line or under the referring employee. Any actual or potential conflict must be promptly disclosed to management or Human Resources.

If you act as a hiring manager, you aren't allowed to hire your partner to your team. You can disclose your relationship when you refer them for employment to other teams or departments where you don't have any managerial or hiring authority to avoid any conflict of interest.

We respect the rights of employees related to activities outside employment which are private in nature. Similarly, employees are required to refrain from any activity which would negatively impact the organization or its ability to do business in India or elsewhere. In the event of a situation where the employee is in doubt, the matter should be brought to the attention of the HR/HOD, who will act as appropriate. Any decision by the management shall be deemed final and will not be challenged.

EMPLOYEE RELATIONSHIPS

We want to ensure that relationships between employees are appropriate and harmonious. We have outlined the guidelines and expect you to always behave professionally.

Fraternisation

Fraternization refers to dating or being friends with your colleagues. In this policy, "dating" equals consensual romantic relationships and sexual relations. Non-consensual relationships constitute sexual violence, and we prohibit them explicitly.

Dating Colleagues: If you start dating a colleague, we expect you to maintain professionalism and keep personal discussions outside of our workplace. You are also obliged to respect your colleagues who date each other. We won't tolerate sexual jokes, malicious gossip and improper comments. If you witness this kind of behavior, please report it to HR.

Dating Managers: To avoid accusations of favoritism, abuse of authority and sexual harassment, supervisors must not date their direct reports. This restriction extends to every manager who has an employee/team.

Also, Friendships at work Employees who work together may naturally form friendships either in or outside of the workplace. We encourage this relationship between peers, as it can help you communicate and collaborate. But we expect you to focus on your work and keep personal disputes outside of our workplace.

GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL

SAMTA thrives on its open-door policy culture. Our grievance procedure reflects a process that promotes open dialogue to resolve conflicts or disagreements. All conflicts can be addressed using our first principles & values of trust and respect. Any aggrieved employee is suggested to consult

her/his reporting manager regarding actions/occurrences or attitudes either expressed or implied that are perceived as unfair discriminatory.

If a satisfactory resolution to the problem cannot be reached, the employee can reach out to the HR/HOD/CEO through a written complaint. The management will give fair opportunity to both parties and try and reach an amicable solution in the best interest of the organization.

Our endeavor is to empower our employees to raise and discuss their concerns and be heard in a fair and transparent manner.

We recognize that grievances may occur in the normal course of employment / interaction.

Full recognition is given to the significance of employee grievances and as far as possible the Company maintains that all grievances will be dealt with without undue delay and in a fair and reasonable manner at the earliest possible stage of the procedure.

A grievance is a situation where the following has occurred or likely to occur and involves employees or non-employees working with [SAMTA](#):

- Acts of indiscipline
- Lack of adherence to company policy / norms
- Ethical or integrity issues
- Questions about interpretation or any point not covered explicitly in policy
- Performance issues
- Interpersonal relations between team members and managers
- Professional/personal stress affecting performance
- Any perceived harassment
- Work conditions, working hours
- Compensation related concerns should be discussed only with manager and HR & is out of scope of this process.

CESSATION OF EMPLOYMENT

In this section, we describe our procedures regarding resignation and termination of our employees. We also refer to our progressive discipline process that may sometimes result in termination.

RESIGNATION

During probation, the employee shall provide 45 days' notice in any reasonable instance of separation and SAMTA shall provide one-day notice in cases of termination without cause. SAMTA can extend the said notice period upto 90 days if the employee is aligned to any live billable project.

Upon completion of the employment probation period and confirmation as a full-time employee, the employee and SAMTA agree to provide no less than three months (90 days) notice in a separation to each other. Employee is encouraged to discuss the resignation intention with HR and/or functional manager before formal resignation email is sent.

If the employee is working on client engagement / project while resigning from the company, employee cannot communicate directly to the client about the resignation. This is highly unprofessional behavior, which can sabotage SAMTA's relationship with the client and impact our business. Resignation needs to be internally discussed with the reporting manager and HR, who will arrange a replacement and inform client at the appropriate time along with the impact mitigation plan. Hence, serving 90 days' notice period is critical for smooth transition. Employee will get final relieving date from SAMTA, after aligning all the stakeholders and agreed replacement plan with client, employee, and manager.

TERMINATION

SAMTA may dismiss the employee with cause and without notice for willful misconduct contrary to its policies and may pursue legal recourse to protect the Company's Interest. Grounds for dismissal include, but are not limited to:

- Misconduct inconsistent with the fulfilment of the express and implied conditions of service
- Any willful breach or continued neglect of the employment terms and conditions
- Any willful neglect of the duties assigned to you from time to time
- Consistent performance issues
- Any action sabotaging SAMTA's credibility and reputation externally or internally.

The company may terminate your employment without any notice or payment in lieu of notice.

LEAVE DURING NOTICE PERIOD

Employees are not eligible to take leave during the notice period. This is to facilitate smooth transition of responsibilities and knowledge transfer.

In case of an emergency including medical reasons, the employee might be granted leave as an exception by the HOD provided the employee submits the supporting documents to support the leave request.

If the leave is approved the notice period may be extended accordingly by the said number of days.

NOTICE PERIOD BUYOUT

Any employee who resigns from the services of the company needs to serve the required notice period. The employees on bench (i.e. without active billable project) may get an option to buy out the

notice period from the date mutually agreed by the functional manager and HR. Buyout of notice period is a mutually agreed option and can be availed only if the relieving date is approved by the function head.

RETIREMENT

The retirement age for all the executives shall be 65 years. Employees shall retire on the last day of the month in which they attain the retirement age.

LAST WORKING DAY (LWD)

A resigned or terminated employee should properly hand over his or her responsibilities and all company property in their possession. The employee's reporting manager or HR department may take a handover and sign-off the separation handover form. The LWD must be mutually agreed on and signed off by the reporting manager.

The full and final (FnF) settlement shall be completed within 30 working days of the Last Working Day of the employee, and any dues shall be settled by either party.

POLICY REVISION

We will always strive for fairness and equal opportunity and penalize offensive and illegal behaviours. But, as laws and our environment change, we may revise and modify some of our policies. We have established an [annual] revision of our handbook to bring it up to date with legislation and employment trends.

We also ask you to contact HR if you spot any inconsistencies or mistakes. And, if you have any ideas about how to improve our workplace, we are happy to hear them.

AMENDMENTS / EXCEPTIONS / INTERPRETATION

All the policies and procedures mentioned in this handbook are subject to modifications from time to time at the discretion of the management. Exceptions, if any, will need the approval of Head HR/Management Team. The decision of the Head of HR shall also be final and conclusive in the event of an interpretation of a provision of the policy.

ADDENDUM: HOLIDAY LIST - 2026

This addendum is issued as part of the Policy Handbook.

The following holidays will be observed:

HOLIDAY LIST FOR 2026

Sr.no	Date	Day	Occasion
1	01-Jan-26	Wednesday	New Year's Day
2	14-Jan-26	Wednesday	Makar Sakranthi
3	26-Jan-26	Monday	Republic Day
4	04-Mar-26	Wednesday	Holi
5	03-Apr-26	Friday	Good Friday
6	01-May-26	Friday	Buddha Purnima/May Day
7	14-Sept-26	Monday	Ganesh Chaturthi
8	02-Oct-26	Friday	Gandhi Jayanti
9	20-Oct-26	Tuesday	Dussehra
10	09-Nov-26	Monday	Diwali
11	25-Dec-26	Friday	Christmas
12			Birthday Leave